

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

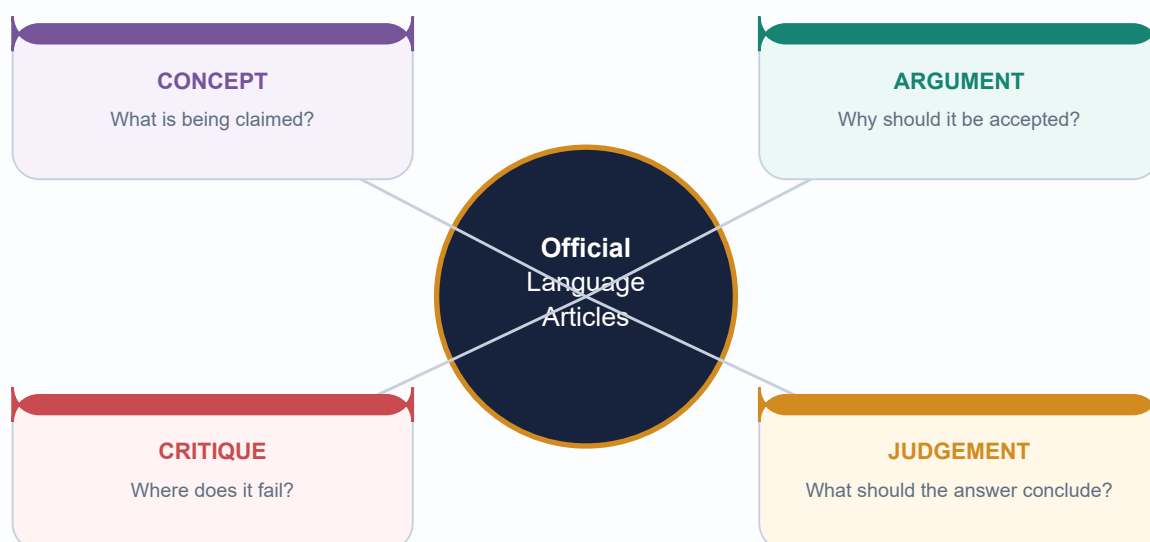
Official Language (Articles 343–351) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Official-Language.md + 40_Official-Language.md

Learning cards: 17



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-I / GS-II***Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

STATIC THEORY

• greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/40_Official-Language.md.*

MEMORY HOOK

greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/40_Official-Language.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/40_Official-Language.md.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core
Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Official language of Union	Hindi (Devanagari) — Art 343
English	15 yrs (1950–65); continues indefinitely via Official Languages Act 1963
Eighth Schedule	22 languages (originally 14)
Linguistic Minorities Officer	Art 350-B (7th Amdt 1956)
National language	NONE (India has no national language)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation • Core idea • Part 1

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hindi in Devanagari is the **official language of the Union** (Art 343) — but **not a "national language."** English was to end in **1965**, yet the **Official Languages Act 1963** keeps it **indefinitely**. States may choose their own official language (**not limited to the 8th Schedule**).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

Dimension 1 Hindi in Devanagari is the official language of the Union (Art 343) — but not a "national language." English was to end in 1965, yet the Official Lang	Dimension 2 greater than □ No national language — only an official one. Big UPSC trap.
Dimension 3 greater than □ 8th Schedule = 22 langs. Additions: Sindhi (1967) · Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992) ·	Dimension 4 greater than Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhal (2003).

STATIC THEORY

- greater than □ **No national language** — only an **official** one. Big UPSC trap.
- greater than □ 8th Schedule = **22** langs. Additions: **Sindhi (1967)** · **Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992)** ·
- greater than **Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhal (2003)**.
- greater than □ SC/HC and authoritative legislative texts ordinarily use **English**. Under Art
- greater than 348(2), a Governor with the President's consent may authorise Hindi/another state official
- greater than language in HC proceedings; **Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7** separately permits it in

MEMORY HOOK

greater than **No national language** — only an **official** one. Big UPSC trap. | greater than **8th Schedule = 22 langs**. Additions: **Sindhi (1967)** · **Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali (1992)** · | greater than **SC/HC** and authoritative legislative texts ordinarily use **English**. Under Art

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation • Core idea • Part 2

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than HC judgments/decrees/orders if accompanied by an authorised English translation.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation • Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ First Official Language Commission = **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by **G.B. Pant** committee.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts



Dimension 1 □ First Official Language Commission = B.G. Kher (1955); examined by G.B. Pant committee.	Dimension 2 □ Committee of Parliament on Official Language = 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS), chaired by Home Minister.
Dimension 3 □ Art 351: Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a medium of expression	Dimension 4 for all elements of India's composite culture.

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STATIC THEORY

- □ Committee of Parliament on Official Language = **30 members (20 LS + 10 RS)**, chaired by **Home Minister**.
- □ **Art 351**: Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a ****medium of expression**
- for all elements of India's composite culture**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. First Official Language Commission = **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by **G.B. Pant** committee.
2. Committee of Parliament on Official Language = **30 members (20 LS + 10 RS)**, chaired by **Home Minister**.
3. **Art 351**: Union duty to develop Hindi so it may serve as a ****medium of expression**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know
Facts

HIGH

Foundation • Current linkGS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 **Classical Language** status (a *separate scheme*, not the 8th Schedule): **Oct 2024** added **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali** → total **11**. **NEP three-language formula** row with **Tamil Nadu** over "Hindi imposition"; demands to add ~38 more languages to the 8th Schedule.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of  Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —

ADVANCED / COMPLETE →  Current link

HIGH

Advanced • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-I / GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

Dimension 1

greater than Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) ·
GS Paper: GS-I / GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 65 (Part XVII; direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official update.

Dimension 3

greater than  = from source book ·  = inference / analysis
·  = official-source update.

Dimension 4

greater than Companion: basic/Official-Language.md.

STATIC THEORY

• greater than **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 65 (Part XVII; direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official update.

• greater than  = from source book ·  = inference / analysis ·  = official-source update.

• greater than *Companion: basic/Official-Language.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = official-source update.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core
Foundation

HIGH

Advanced • PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□ • Part 1

GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ **Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union**; numerals = **international

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343–344) □□: RECALL MAP

PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□

Dimension 1 □ Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union; numerals = international	Dimension 2 (Indian) form, not Devanagari.
Dimension 3 □ English to continue for 15 years (1950–1965); Parliament may extend its use beyond that.	Dimension 4 □ Language Commissions (5th & 10th year): first under B.G. Kher (1955); examined by a parliamentary

STATIC THEORY

- (Indian) form**, not Devanagari.
- □ **English** to continue for **15 years (1950–1965)**; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
- □ **Language Commissions** (5th & 10th year): first under **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by a parliamentary
- committee under **G.B. Pant (1957)**.
- □ **Official Languages Act, 1963** — allows **English indefinitely** (no time limit) alongside Hindi;
- **amended 1967** to make English use **compulsory** in certain cases (a response to anti-Hindi agitation in the South).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union**; numerals = **international
2. **English** to continue for **15 years (1950–1965)**; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
3. **Language Commissions** (5th & 10th year): first under **B.G. Kher (1955)**; examined by a parliamentary
4. **Official Languages Act, 1963** — allows **English indefinitely** (no time limit) alongside Hindi;

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A —
LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344)

□□

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344) □□ · Part 2

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than □ **Key trap:** Hindi is the **official** language — **NOT** the "national language." India has ****no** national

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- greater than language** (constitutionally).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A —
LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344)

□□

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Constitution does **not** specify states' official languages — a **state legislature** may adopt any language(s)

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345–347) □: RECALL MAP

PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) □



Dimension 1 □ Constitution does not specify states' official languages — a state legislature may adopt any language(s)	Dimension 2 in use OR Hindi; until then, English continues.
Dimension 3 □ □ A state's choice is NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).	Dimension 4 □ Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the President may direct official recognition of

STATIC THEORY

- in use OR Hindi; until then, **English** continues.
- □ □ A state's choice is **NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule** (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).
- □ **Art 347:** On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the **President** may direct official recognition of
- a language in a state (protects linguistic minorities).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Constitution does **not** specify states' official languages — a **state legislature** may adopt any language(s)
2. ☐ A state's choice is **NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule** (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).
3. **Art 347**: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the **President** may direct official recognition of

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
 ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B —
 REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347) ☐

HIGH
Advanced · PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349) ☐

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

- ☐ **SC & HC proceedings** and **authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances** → **English only** (until

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (ARTS 348–349) ☐: RECALL MAP
PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349) ☐

Dimension 1 ☐ SC & HC proceedings and authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances → English only (until	Dimension 2 Parliament provides otherwise).
Dimension 3 ☐ A Governor, with the President's prior consent, may authorise Hindi/another	Dimension 4 state official language in High Court proceedings under Art 348(2). Separately, Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7 permits it in HC judgments/decrees/or

STATIC THEORY

- Parliament provides otherwise).
- ☐ A **Governor**, with the **President's prior consent**, may authorise Hindi/another
- state official language in **High Court proceedings** under Art 348(2). Separately, **Official Languages Act, 1963 s.7** permits it in HC judgments/decrees/orders if an authorised English translation accompanies them.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. SC & HC proceedings and authoritative texts of all bills/acts/ordinances → English only (until
2. A Governor, with the President's prior consent, may authorise Hindi/another

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C —
LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts
348–349) □

HIGH**Advanced · PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351) □**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

- **Art 350:** right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (ARTS 350–351) □: RECALL MAP**PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351) □**

Dimension 1 □ Art 350: right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.	Dimension 2 □ Art 350-A: mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.
Dimension 3 □ Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities (added by 7th	Dimension 4 Amendment, 1956); headquarters moved from Allahabad to New Delhi on 1 June 2015.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Art 350-A:** mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.
- □ **Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities** (added by **7th
- Amendment, 1956); **headquarters moved from Allahabad to New Delhi** on 1 June 2015**.
- □ **Art 351:** duty of the **Union to develop Hindi** so it may serve as a medium
- of expression for all elements of India's composite culture (enriched from Hindustani/Sanskrit/Eighth-Schedule languages).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Art 350**: right to represent grievances in any language used in the Union/State.
2. **Art 350-A**: mother-tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities.
3. **Art 350-B: Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities** (added by **7th
4. **Art 351**: duty of the **Union to develop Hindi** so it may serve as a medium

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
 ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D —
 SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351) □

HIGH**Advanced · PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE** □□GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

- Currently **22 languages** (originally **14**).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE □□: RECALL MAP**PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE** □□

Dimension 1 □ Currently 22 languages (originally 14).	Dimension 2 □ Additions: Sindhi (21st Amdt, 1967); Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali (71st Amdt, 1992); Bodo, Dogri,
Dimension 3 Maithili, Santhali (92nd Amdt, 2003).	Dimension 4 □ Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

STATIC THEORY

- □ Additions: **Sindhi** (21st Amdt, **1967**); **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali** (71st Amdt, **1992**); **Bodo, Dogri,
- Maithili, Santhali (**92nd Amdt**, 2003**).
- □ Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Currently **22 languages** (originally **14**).
2. Additions: **Sindhi** (21st Amdt, **1967**); **Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali** (71st Amdt, **1992**); **Bodo, Dogri,
3. Purpose: (a) representation on the Official Language Commission; (b) enrichment of Hindi.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
 ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART E — THE
 EIGHTH SCHEDULE □□

HIGH

Advanced · Committee of Parliament on Official Language □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Set up under the 1963 Act (constituted **1976**); **30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS**; by convention **chaired by the Union Home Minister**; reviews the progress of Hindi and reports to the **President**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

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1. Set up under the 1963 Act (constituted **1976**); **30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS**; by convention **chaired by the Union Home Minister**; reviews the progress of Hindi and reports to the **President**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Committee of
Parliament on Official Language □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Hindi is the "national language"

CORRECT: it is the **official language of the Union**; India has no national language.

WRONG: The Eighth Schedule has 18 languages

CORRECT: **22** (originally 14).

WRONG: States must pick an official language from the Eighth Schedule

CORRECT: **not restricted** to it.

WRONG: English use ended in 1965

CORRECT: **Official Languages Act 1963** continues it **indefinitely**.

WRONG: Classical-language status is under the Eighth Schedule

CORRECT: it is a **separate government scheme**, unrelated to the 8th Schedule.

WRONG: HC judgments can be delivered in Hindi with Governor's nod

CORRECT: only **proceedings**; judgments/orders remain in English.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced • CA hooks (official-source verified)

GS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Classical Language** status (a **separate scheme**, not the 8th Schedule): **Oct 2024** — **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese & Bengali** added, taking the total to **11** (earlier 6: Tamil-2004, Sanskrit-2005, Kannada & Telugu-2008, Malayalam-2013, Odia-2014). □ **NEP 2020 "three-language formula"** row — **Tamil Nadu's** opposition to alleged **Hindi imposition**;

INTRO & ORIGIN

federal-language politics.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- Pending **demands to add ~38 languages** (Bhojpuri, Rajasthani, etc.) to the **Eighth Schedule**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks
(official-source verified)

HIGH

Advanced • Mains angles

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"India has an official language but no national language." Discuss the constitutional wisdom of this scheme. The three-language formula and the federal tension over Hindi imposition. Should the Eighth Schedule be expanded? Weigh linguistic justice against administrative feasibility.

STUDY LINK

Official Language (Articles 343–351) —
ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI